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From Services to SaaS: Creating a Service-First, Product-Next Startup for International Trade Companies

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ABSTRACT

This work presents the development of a Service-First, Product-Next B2B startup focused on the international trade sector. The startup emerges from the intersection of entrepreneurial experience and a culture of continuous innovation, emphasizing close customer interaction, rapid experimentation, and validated learning as core principles. Initially, the team provides consulting-like services to identify client pain points, map workflows, and co-create tailored solutions, generating immediate value while acquiring deep sector knowledge.

Building on prior entrepreneurial experience and a network inherited from previous ventures, the startup applies these insights to design scalable software-as-a-service (SaaS) products that address real market needs. The approach is guided by a community-oriented mindset, fostering collaboration with clients and partners to create sustainable and impactful solutions. This work highlights the importance of practical experimentation as a foundation for developing products that are both relevant and effective, demonstrating a model that integrates academic rigor, systemic thinking, and market pragmatism in the process of creating innovative B2B solutions.

Keywords: SaaS; B2B; Business Model Validation; Product Development.

LIST OF ACRONYMS

- **SaaS** – Software as a Service
- **B2B** – Business to Business

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1. Introduction

This work presents the development of a B2B startup guided by the Service-First, Product-Next model, focusing on the creation of SaaS solutions to automate the issuance and receipt of Electronic Service Invoices (NFS-e) in the context of international trade. The startup originates from the founders' previous entrepreneurial experience, inheriting from Clonex values such as resilience, pragmatism, and an established client network. Initial operations focus on the international trade sector, identifying urgent needs and automation opportunities while aiming to develop a scalable product aligned with market demands.

1.1 Problem

The Brazilian international trade market faces complex and often manual fiscal processes. Issuance and receipt of NFS-e involve multiple channels, manual entries, risk of inconsistencies, lack of traceability, and auditing difficulties. Existing tools, such as ERPs and taxtechs, only partially meet these needs, leaving gaps in integration, automation, and real-time visibility. These factors lead to rework, increased costs, and exposure to fiscal risks, highlighting the need for automated and scalable solutions.

1.2 Objectives

The general objective of this work is to develop a SaaS solution to automate the issuance and receipt of NFS-e, starting with applied consultancy and gradually evolving into a scalable product.

1.2.1 Specific Objectives

Map and understand the problems and needs of the international trade sector related to NFS-e issuance and receipt;

Apply Service-First practices to co-create solutions with clients, validating business hypotheses;

Develop prototypes and MVPs using technologies such as n8n, Supabase, OCR, and AI APIs;

Ensure data security, compliance, and integrity according to LGPD;

Evaluate technical feasibility and scalability of the solution for subsequent SaaS development;

Generate dashboards and KPIs for real-time monitoring and control.

2. Methodology

The methodology combines applied research with incremental development, guided by Action Research, enabling continuous learning from practical interactions with clients and hypothesis validation in real scenarios.

2.1 Action Research Methodology

Action Research focuses on solving real-world problems collaboratively with stakeholders, promoting continuous learning and adjustment. In this startup, it was used to identify client pain points, map NFS-e workflows, test technical solutions, and validate the feasibility of a scalable SaaS product.

2.2 Action Research Approach

The Action Research cycle involved iterative steps of diagnosis, planning, implementation, evaluation, and reflection. Each project module — from business discovery to final product consolidation — corresponded to a sprint with hypotheses, experiments, and validations. This approach ensured that solutions were aligned with real market needs and allowed the technological architecture to be adjusted according to practical results.

3. Project Context

The project was structured into four main modules, focusing on NFS-e automation in the Brazilian international trade sector.

3.1 Startup Background

The founding team brings entrepreneurial experience and a culture of continuous innovation inherited from Clonex. Core values include resilience, pragmatism, validated learning, and collaboration with clients and partners. Initial operations target micro and small companies in international trade, leveraging pre-existing connections and addressing urgent market needs.

3.2 Market Context

The fiscal automation market in Brazil—particularly related to the issuance and management of Electronic Service Invoices (NFS-e) within the foreign trade sector—is undergoing a structural and technological transformation. In 2024, the country registered approximately 28,800 exporting companies and 55,800 importing companies, reflecting the sector's economic relevance and operational complexity (Sebrae, 2024). Additionally, the service sector accounted for 61.6% of newly established companies, mostly composed of micro and small enterprises that face significant challenges in fiscal compliance and document control.

The issuance of NFS-e remains fragmented across more than 5,000 municipalities, of which only around 1,037 (19%) have adopted the new national standard (Fenacon, 2024). This heterogeneity of layouts, protocols, and local regulations increases system maintenance costs and compliance risks. Companies operating in multiple jurisdictions—such as those in foreign trade—face even greater complexity in handling diverse XML/RPS formats and digital certification requirements, making current manual processes slow, error-prone, and expensive in terms of fiscal operations.

In this context, fiscal automation emerges as a driver of efficiency and competitiveness. The integration of ERPs with automated NFS-e issuance and validation platforms eliminates manual steps and significantly reduces operational errors and compliance costs. Technologies such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), Robotic Process Automation (RPA), and Machine Learning (ML) have been applied to interpret fiscal documents in multiple formats, extract data from PDFs and emails, and automatically insert them into accounting systems—reducing processing time by up to 85% (Fenacon, 2024; UiPath, 2023).

With the implementation of Complementary Law No. 214/2024, which will make the national NFS-e standard mandatory from January 2026, the market is expected to consolidate around scalable and interoperable solutions. This regulatory milestone represents a strategic innovation window, enabling the emergence of unified SaaS platforms that combine issuance, validation, reconciliation, and fiscal analytics within a single ecosystem.

Although the market already includes established players such as TecnoSpeed, Codemasters, eNotas, and NFe.io, there remain significant gaps in automation tailored to the foreign trade context—particularly regarding the management of invoices from multiple municipalities and integration with systems like Siscomex and DUIMP. Furthermore, there is a notable shortage of solutions that provide predictive fiscal intelligence, integrated analytical reporting, and simplified user interfaces designed for small and medium-sized enterprises.

From a technological perspective, the adoption of cloud-native architectures, microservices, RESTful APIs, and event-driven architectures (EDA) is fundamental to ensuring scalability, resilience, and low latency in large-scale fiscal data processing. Complementarily, the application of Big Data and Business Intelligence (BI) enhances analytical capacity, enabling continuous monitoring of fiscal indicators and early detection of inconsistencies.

Regulatory frameworks such as the General Data Protection Law (LGPD, Law No. 13.709/2018) and Bank Secrecy Law (Complementary Law No. 105/2001) impose strict requirements for data privacy and security. As a result, automated fiscal

solutions must implement end-to-end encryption, granular access control, and continuous auditing. Compliance with these standards represents not only a legal obligation but also a competitive advantage in Brazil's expanding digital fiscal ecosystem.

In summary, the market context demonstrates a growing demand for automated, interoperable, and secure solutions capable of addressing new regulatory standards while reducing the operational burden caused by Brazil's tax fragmentation. The convergence of digital transformation, regulatory reform, and automation technologies establishes a fertile ground for innovation and growth in the NFS-e automation market for international trade companies.

3.3 Business Model and Approach

The startup applies the Service-First, Product-Next model, beginning with applied consultancy to identify pain points, map workflows, and co-create solutions. This phase generates immediate revenue, provides practical learning, and forms the foundation for a scalable SaaS product.

3.4 Technical Context

The technical architecture involves:

- **n8n**: low-code workflow automation;
- **Supabase**: scalable database and storage;
- **OCR/OpenCV and AI APIs**: automatic data extraction from NFS-e;
- **Integration with ERP**s and existing systems;
- **Monitoring**, **logging**, and **manual fallback** for risk mitigation.

3.5 Risks and Requirements

Critical risks include ERP integration, OCR/AI accuracy, data security, and dependence on external APIs. Functional requirements cover automatic capture, validation, normalization, and secure storage of NFS-e, alongside minimal

dashboards. Non-functional requirements include availability, scalability, security, observability, and modularity.

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4 Module Artifacts

Module 3 focused on the transition of the project from a validated MVP to an operationally evidenced product-service with commercial readiness, building directly upon the conception and implementation groundwork consolidated in Module 2. While the previous module centered on defining the value proposition, structuring an initial business model, and deploying a functional MVP with pilot clients, this stage advanced the project toward operational maturity, strategic consolidation, and commercial structuring. The main objective of Module 3 was to convert field learnings from the Design Partner into measurable evidence, formalize the operational playbook required to scale delivery without founder dependency, structure the commercial strategy with market sizing and value-based pricing, and evaluate the conditions under which the service-delivery model can evolve into a scalable product core. Throughout the module, technical, operational, and commercial dimensions were progressively tightened through the Service as a Software (SaaSo) framework and the Forward Deployed Engineering (FDE) model, ensuring that every artifact produced — from telemetry baselines to the RACI matrix, from the TAM/SAM/SOM analysis to the FDE Bible — was anchored in empirical data collected during the active operation with the pilot client.

Sprint 1 – Initial Prototyping and Operational Evidence in Production

Sprint 1 of Module 3 focused on operating the MVP within the Design Partner's production environment and on structuring the strategic evolution of the project through three organizational constructs: the Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE) role, the Product TechLead role, and the Service as a Software (SaaSo) operating model. The objective of this sprint was to convert the solution — until then validated in controlled conditions — into a live operation capable of generating real telemetry, surfacing hidden constraints, and producing the first layer of empirical evidence required to qualify both the product and the business model.

The technical prototype put into production articulates four elements that together constitute the automation flow: Qive as the NFS-e capture provider, n8n as the workflow orchestrator, Supabase as the persistence and authentication layer, and the Conexos ERP as the final destination through mimetized internal endpoints. The

pipeline was deployed in three coordinated n8n workflows — one for orchestration, one for ingestion, and one for processing and posting to the ERP — with the explicit design principle of keeping operational complexity low while preserving the ability to audit every state transition of a fiscal document. The mimetization of ERP endpoints was adopted in place of traditional API integration because Conexos does not expose a formal public API, and the reproduction of internal requests proved to be the only viable path to achieve functional integration within the MVP timeframe.

The first cycle of operation in the pilot environment enabled the collection of a structured baseline of telemetry. Over a controlled window, one thousand workflow executions were analyzed, exposing that only 3.51% of the processed records reached finalization under fully automated conditions. The median time observed between invoice creation (created_at) and successful posting (saved_date) was approximately 17.8 seconds for the records that completed the flow without intervention, which confirmed that the technical backbone was performing within acceptable latency. The decisive finding, however, was that 60.6% of the blockers were caused by absent or incorrect document configuration in the client's ERP environment — not by failures in the automation itself. This result reframed the improvement strategy of the MVP: the priority shifted from engineering optimization toward structural remediation of cadastral data and governance of document parameters.

In parallel with technical deployment, Sprint 1 formalized the organizational constructs that underlie the operating model of Clonex. The Forward Deployed Engineer was defined, following the reference of Palantir's field engineering practice, as the technical professional embedded in the client that translates operational reality into engineering decisions and feeds learning back into the product. The Product TechLead was defined as the counterpart role inside the company, responsible for converting field discoveries into structured backlog, reusable components, and documented domain knowledge. Together, these two roles articulate the loop by which service delivery, rather than disappearing as one-off consultancy, is systematically harvested into the product.

The operating model itself was consolidated as Service as a Software (SaaSo). Unlike a conventional Software as a Service offering, SaaSo acknowledges that

automation in Brazilian customs and tax environments cannot be sold as a generic self-service product without first being embedded inside the client's concrete operational context. Under this model, the service layer — composed of the FDE presence, the reconciliation routines, and the domain expertise — is treated as part of the delivered value, while the software layer captures, standardizes, and gradually absorbs the repeatable patterns of that service. This positioning explains why Clonex enters the client as a Mission Partner rather than as a traditional software vendor, and why the FDE Bible was elected as the instrument to codify the playbook of that mission.

The governance of the solution in the pilot environment was reinforced by the creation of a user interface layer that exposes the status of processed invoices, flags exceptions, and allows manual intervention by the client's operators on records that cannot be automatically finalized. This interface is intentionally decoupled from the processing pipeline: it reads from the persistence layer, and it does not execute business rules on its own. The separation of concerns preserves the auditability of the flow and allows the interface to evolve without affecting the ingestion or processing workflows, which is essential during the iterative validation phase.

Sprint 1 closed with the prototype running in production against real fiscal documents, the first baseline of telemetry collected from the Design Partner, and the operating model explicitly named and documented. The low finalization rate observed at this stage was not treated as a failure of the MVP, but as the correct signal that the bottleneck of the operation is located in the structural quality of cadastral data — a diagnosis that could only be produced by operating the system in real conditions. This finding became the empirical foundation that justified, in the subsequent sprints, the refinement of the SaaSo model, the expansion of reconciliation routines, and the strategic framing of the Fiscal Hub as a lever of governance rather than a mere automation tool.

Sprint 2 – Strategic References and SaaSo Consolidation

Sprint 2 focused on consolidating the theoretical and architectural foundation of the Service as a Software (SaaSo) model applied to the project, through the explicit

adoption of strategic references that inform both the product philosophy and the operational posture. The objective was to move beyond intuition in the definition of the operating model and anchor the choices made during implementation in references that have been field-tested at scale in comparable contexts, thereby producing a Definition of Done (DoD) that is both ambitious and verifiable.

Two external references were incorporated as structural pillars of the model. The first is Paul Graham's principle of "Do things that don't scale", which legitimizes the hands-on, embedded, and deliberately non-automated posture adopted by the FDE during the early phase of each client engagement, under the premise that manual and assisted operation is the fastest route to discover the rules that can later be codified into software. The second is Palantir's concept of ontology as a semantic layer that unifies heterogeneous data sources under a consistent domain model, which was mapped onto the fiscal domain of the project as the justification for treating the persistence layer not as a passive storage but as the authoritative representation of the client's fiscal reality.

Building upon these references, the SaaSo Definition of Done was formalized around three operational pillars: telemetry, proactivity, and mimetization. Telemetry is the commitment that every execution of the automation flow leaves an auditable trace — including timestamps of state transitions, error codes, and the final outcome of each document — enabling the product team to diagnose behavior with data instead of anecdote. Proactivity is the commitment that the system does not merely react to user actions: it identifies exceptions, surfaces them to the operator, and, whenever possible, triggers remediation routines on its own. Mimetization, finally, is the commitment that the integration layer reproduces the internal requests of the target ERP with enough fidelity to operate as if it were a legitimate internal module, accepting as a premise that Conexos does not expose a public API and that the absence of such an interface must be compensated by a controlled reverse-engineering approach. The limitations of each pillar at the current stage of maturity were documented explicitly, so that the DoD functions as a yardstick of evolution rather than as an aspirational statement.

The architectural distinction between SaaS and SaaSo was also articulated during this sprint. Whereas a conventional SaaS is sold as a generic, multi-tenant,

self-serve product whose value increases with standardization, SaaSo accepts that the target domain is too heterogeneous for immediate standardization and therefore absorbs part of the delivery as embedded service. The implication is that the software boundary is porous and expands gradually, as repeatable patterns are captured from the field and converted into reusable components by the Product TechLead. Sprint 2 closed with this framework consolidated in writing, with the DoD mapped against concrete verification artifacts from the pilot operation, and with the operational posture of the team explicitly aligned to the assisted-operation principle of the cited references

Sprint 3 – Commercial Strategy, Market Sizing, and Value-Based Pricing

Sprint 3 focused on translating the operational evidence accumulated in the Design Partner into a structured commercial strategy, articulating the market opportunity, the pricing logic, and the economic justification of the solution in quantitative terms. The objective of this sprint was to exit the intuitive phase of pricing and sizing, in which numbers were treated as educated estimates, and enter a phase in which every commercial parameter — ticket, market size, captured value — is derived from auditable data and explicit methodological choices. The artifacts produced in this sprint are the direct input for the go-to-market plan and for the conversations that will be held with future prospects.

The market sizing exercise produced explicit estimates at the three canonical levels. The Total Addressable Market (TAM) was estimated at approximately R$ 1.2 billion per year, calculated from a universe of approximately 40,000 importing companies in Brazil multiplied by an average reference ticket of R$ 2,500 per month. The Serviceable Available Market (SAM), restricted to companies with operational profile compatible with the SaaSo model and with regulatory exposure that justifies automation, was estimated at approximately R$ 420 million per year, corresponding to approximately 10,000 companies under an average ticket of R$ 3,500 per month. The Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM), recalibrated during the sprint cycle to reflect the actual constraints of a high-touch operating model without a validated playbook or a team independent of the founders, was positioned at 6 to 12 active clients over a 24-month horizon, corresponding to an Annual Recurring Revenue between R$ 576 thousand and R$ 1.15 million at a ticket of R$ 8,000 per month. The

previously declared horizon of 30 to 60 clients was preserved as a 36 to 48 month aspiration, conditioned on three preconditions: a validated FDE Bible, at least two success cases with auditable ROI, and a technical team independent of the founders.

The coexistence of distinct ticket references — R$ 2,500 in the TAM, R$ 3,500 in the SAM, R$ 8,000 in the SOM, and R$ 15,000 to R$ 20,000 in the operational pricing model — was declared explicitly as a hierarchy of tickets. Each level is a response to a different question: the TAM ticket reflects the average price that would be accessible to the full population of importing companies if the solution were maximally horizontal; the SAM ticket reflects the premium compatible with the subset of companies whose regulatory exposure already qualifies them as buyers; the SOM ticket reflects the concrete commercial expectation of a high-touch service during the ramp-up; and the operational pricing reflects the value-based range that is applied to clients in which the full Fiscal Hub is delivered. This explicit declaration eliminates the appearance of analytical inconsistency for external readers and reframes the dispersion as segmentation coherence.

The pricing framework itself was constructed through a value-based pricing methodology, applied to the data collected from the active operation with the Design Partner. Based on the baseline accumulated during the pilot, the captured qualified value for the reference client profile was estimated at approximately R$ 1.58 million per year, distributed across three categories: hard and auditable savings (such as prevention of lost invoices, elimination of duplicates, capture of timeliness discounts, and mitigation of undue charges), indirect verification gains (such as reduction of data entry errors and improvement of managerial classification), and strategic and risk-mitigation benefits (such as reconciliation of withholdings and audit readiness). Applying a capture rate of 10% to 15% over the qualified value, the resulting monthly ticket was derived as R$ 15,000 to R$ 20,000 per month, complemented by a setup fee for the implementation phase. This is therefore not a projected number: it is the output of an exercise anchored in real data, filtered by an explicit economic elegibility factor, and directly traceable to the categories of savings documented in the ROI file.

The ROI documentation produced in parallel with the pricing framework structured the categories of economic value of the solution into eight verifiable sources: direct operational savings, prevention of lost invoices, elimination of duplicates, detection of

incorrect values, correction of process-vendor mismatches, reconciliation of fiscal withholdings, correct classification of expense nature and cost center, and capture of timeliness discounts coupled with mitigation of undue charges. Each category was described with the mechanism by which the system captures or prevents the loss, allowing a prospective client to map its own operation against the categories and estimate its own captured value. The document was anonymized to protect the commercial confidentiality of the Design Partner: all nominal references were replaced by a parameterized profile named “Trading Company de Referência” with annual revenue of approximately R$ 12 billion, preserving the analytical force of the business case without exposing unauthorized parties.

Finally, Sprint 3 quantified the delta between the current maturity of the operation and the maturity required to qualify each of the three SaaSo pillars. More than 32,000 workflow execution records and approximately 19,500 records of invoice-status vigency had been accumulated in the persistence layer since the start of the pilot, providing the raw material for a reconciliation routine that cross-checks, on a daily basis, the state of each fiscal document between the automation and the ERP. This routine was incorporated as an additional deliverable of the sprint, serving both as a proactivity mechanism and as a source of evidence for future audits. Sprint 3 thus produced an integrated commercial artifact: a market with declared size, a ticket with declared methodology, a ROI with declared categories, and a recalibrated SOM with declared pre-conditions — all of them derived from the operation with the Design Partner.

Sprint 4 – Operational Consolidation: FDE Bible, RACI Matrix, and Fiscal Hub as X-Ray

Sprint 4 focused on converting the operating model consolidated in the previous sprints into a set of explicit and replicable operational artifacts: the FDE Bible, as the playbook that codifies how an engagement is delivered from discovery to handover; the RACI Matrix, as the formalization of responsibilities among the three core roles of the operation; and the Fiscal Hub thesis, as the strategic frame that positions the fiscal layer of the client not as a compliance cost but as a lever of margin and

governance. The objective of this sprint was to reduce the dependency of the operation on the founders, ensuring that a newly onboarded FDE, Tax Analyst, or Customer Success Engineer can read the documents and act with minimal ambiguity, and that a prospect reading the Fiscal Hub thesis understands why the solution is priced as it is.

The FDE Bible was structured in five sequential phases, each with its own Definition of Done. Phase 0 (Discovery and solution design) prescribes the As-Is mapping, gap identification against the ERP, To-Be flow design, mapping of internal endpoints to be mimetized via Postman collection, and the requirements document approved by the client champion. Phase 1 (Proposal submission) formalizes the ROI analysis, the effort and team estimation, and the contract closure. Phase 2 (Agile build and sprint execution) was deepened during this sprint to eliminate the operational fragility previously identified in the central phase of the playbook: it now prescribes explicit, testable, and requirement-linked acceptance criteria per sprint, a change-request protocol that requires formal champion approval for any scope alteration and a contractual revision for alterations exceeding 20% of the original scope, and a minimum communication cadence composed of a daily asynchronous check-in, a weekly status update, a per-sprint planning and review, and an immediate synchronous escalation for critical incidents — with a silence threshold of two business days from the FDE as an operational alert. Phase 3 (Deploy and go-live validation) covers production deployment, assisted monitoring, and ROI collection. Phase 4 (Handover and documentation) delivers the user playbook, the CSE technical manual with the catalog of mimetized endpoints and the dictionary of probable errors, and the formal closure meeting that triggers the sustaining fee. The FDE Bible explicitly declares four principles — quality over speed, autonomy to say no, product focus, and ownership posture — as non-negotiable attitudes of the FDE on the field.

The RACI Matrix formalized, in complementary form, the distribution of responsibilities among the Forward Deployed Engineer, the Tax Analyst, and the Customer Success Engineer across fifteen activities that span the lifecycle of a client — from onboarding to relationship management, reconciliation, SLA monitoring, and delivery approval. The notation was applied rigorously, ensuring that every activity

has exactly one Accountable, and explicitly declaring, through a decision note, the cases in which the same role is both Responsible and Accountable, as happens in the activities of client relationship management, SLA monitoring, and delivery approval under the Customer Success Engineer. This rigor eliminates the dilution of accountability that typically erodes complex operations. In parallel, the Fiscal Hub thesis — embodied in the document that frames the fiscal layer as an X-Ray of the operation — was reinforced with empirical evidence derived from the more than 32,000 telemetry records accumulated in the pilot, and with a qualified value-based pricing range of R$ 15,000 to R$ 20,000 per month derived from captured value of approximately R$ 1.58 million per year. Sprint 4 thus converted what had been conceptual positioning into codified operational infrastructure, moving the project from “we know how we operate” to “we can teach someone else to operate this”.

Sprint 5 – Technical-Commercial Transition and Design Partner Evaluation

Sprint 5 focused on three concurrent axes: the design of the technical-commercial transition plan that defines how the project evolves from service-first delivery toward a product core without losing field intelligence; the application of the corrections requested by the faculty reviewer over the Sprint 4 artifacts, converting declared intention into effective edits in the original documents; and the formalization of the current status of the Design Partner relationship, including the catalog of risks that must be monitored before further commercial expansion. Unlike previous sprints, Sprint 5 prioritized consolidation, correction, and critical assessment over new development, acknowledging that the operational and commercial maturity reached in Sprints 1 through 4 demands a formal evaluation before additional scope is committed.

The technical-commercial transition plan was articulated in two sequential horizons. The first horizon targets the parametrization of the current solution, which today is hard-coded to the operational reality of the Design Partner, by extracting client-specific configuration — such as tax rules, document types, reconciliation tolerances, and ERP endpoints — into an explicit configuration layer that enables onboarding of additional clients without rewriting the core pipeline. The second horizon targets the construction of a low-code interface that allows the Tax Analyst and the Customer Success Engineer to adjust configuration parameters directly,

without requiring FDE intervention for every change, thereby progressively transferring operational autonomy from the engineering team to the operating team. This two-horizon structure materializes the SaaSo principle of porous boundary between service and product: the more the parametrization layer captures the patterns observed in the field, the smaller the service surface required per new client. The correction report for Sprint 4 applied four effective edits: the RACI violation of R/A notation was eliminated by declaring A explicitly with a decision note; Phase 2 of the FDE Bible was expanded with the acceptance criteria, scope protocol, and communication cadence described above; the Fiscal Hub thesis was enriched with an empirical evidence section derived from the Design Partner telemetry; and the calibrations previously recorded as reservations in the Sprint 4 feedback document were propagated to the original Sprint 3 artifacts, including the anonymization of nominal references, the SOM recalibration to 6 to 12 clients over 24 months, and the explicit declaration of the ticket hierarchy.

Finally, the status report on the Design Partner relationship consolidated the capital accumulated and the risks to be monitored. The technical, commercial, and operational capital produced in Module 3 — live telemetry, qualified value calculation, codified playbook, formalized RACI, and anonymized business case — was documented as the asset base on which the next module will build. Six risks were explicitly catalogued: founder dependency in execution, technical risk of the eventual migration from the current cloud architecture, pending authorization for the public use of the Design Partner as a case study, the CSE-onboarding bottleneck that may emerge as new clients are signed, the risk of engagement erosion with the Design Partner if the relationship transitions from co-construction to post-delivery support, and the residual risk of SOM overestimation should the playbook fail to generalize. Each risk was described with its trigger and its mitigation approach, providing a transparent baseline for strategic decisions. Sprint 5 concluded Module 3 by translating the accumulated learning into a transition plan that is simultaneously honest about its constraints and concrete about its next steps, establishing the conditions under which the project can evolve from a Mission Partner model anchored in one Design Partner toward a multi-client operation governed by a validated product core.

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